

Ritika Verma

New York University
19 West Fourth St., 6th Floor,
New York, NY 10012-1119
+1(332)250-7222 (Home) | rv2179@nyu.edu

Education

New York University, USA <i>Ph.D. in Economics</i>	Sept. 2021– 3.82/4
Delhi School of Economics, University of Delhi <i>Master of Arts, Economics (Rank 3 in a batch of 250+ students)</i>	Aug. 2018 – Aug. 2020 81.6% (1224/1500)
Shri Ram College of Commerce, University of Delhi <i>Bachelor in Arts, Economics (Rank 8 in a batch of 150+ students)</i>	Jul. 2015 – May 2018 8.95/10

Research Fields

Entrepreneurial Finance, Microeconomic Theory, Financial Economics, Contract Theory, Corporate Finance Theory

Working Papers

Financing Innovation with Reputation Concerns

In a dynamic model, an investor, financing the project, cannot observe project failure and the entrepreneur, facing career concerns, can hide failure. There is a tension between promoting early disclosure of failure and providing sufficient incentives for it. The optimal contract incentivizes disclosure of failure during an initial transparency stage. This is followed by a delayed disclosure stage, where the failure is disclosed with a lag of random length. The model explains several empirical patterns in venture capital financing and the financing of innovation.

Venture Capital Contracts with Informed Investors

A cashless entrepreneur designs a contract backed by future cash flows to raise funds from an informed investor. The entrepreneur can exert costly effort to improve payoff relevant outcome where the marginal benefit depends on the quality of the project. The quality of the project is observed privately by the investors. This study investigates the optimal contract that an entrepreneur proposes to an investor given these two specific information frictions. In equilibrium, a trade-off emerges between the surplus maximization of projects of different qualities. In particular, this tradeoff creates an endogenous preference for risk by the entrepreneur when designing the menu of contracts. The results are applied to predict the effect of divergence in the entrepreneur's subjective beliefs on the project's outcome and overall efficiency in the economy.

Work in Progress

Price Discrimination with Costly Search

Conference Presentations

Finance Theory Group Summer School <i>University of Washington, Seattle, USA</i>	2025
--	------

6th Annual Economics Conference <i>Ahemdabad University, Gujarat, India</i>	2025
19th Annual Conference on Economic Growth and Development <i>Indian Statistical Institute, New Delhi, India</i>	2024

Teaching Experience

Political Economy (Undergraduate) <i>Teaching Assistant for Prof. Arjada Bardhi</i>	Spring 2026, Spring 2025
Game Theory I (MSQE) <i>Teaching Assistant for Prof. Erik Madsen</i>	Fall 2025, Fall 2024
Intermediate Microeconomics (Undergraduate) <i>Teaching Assistant for Prof. Viplav Saini</i>	Fall 2025, Fall 2024, Spring 2024, Fall 2023
Intermediate Microeconomics (Undergraduate) <i>Main Instructor</i>	Summer 2025, Summer 2024
Intermediate Microeconomics (Undergraduate) <i>Teaching Assistant for Prof. Basil Williams</i>	Spring 2023
Microeconomics I (PhD Core) <i>Teaching Assistant for Prof. Ariel Rubinstein & Prof. Alfred Galichon</i>	Fall 2022

Professional Activities

Service: NYU Micro Theory Student Lunch organizer	2023-2024, 2024-2025
--	----------------------

Pre-PhD Projects

Land Pooling and Project Choice	2020
SEVA: Smart Extension of Vaccine Administration (link) <i>The Geneva Challenge 2019, Graduate Institute of Geneva</i>	Semi Finalist, 2019
Gender Bias, Fertility and Sex Selective Abortions in India	2017

Work Experience

Research Associate <i>CAFRAL, Reserve Bank of India</i>	Sept. 2020 – Jul. 2021 <i>Mumbai, India</i>
Research Assistant (Part-time) <i>Prof. Mausumi Das</i>	Sept. 2020 – Jul. 2021 <i>Delhi School of Economics & Institute of Economic Growth</i>
Summer Intern, Fraud Analytics <i>Barclays Global Service Centre Private Limited</i>	Jun. 2019 – Jul. 2019 <i>Noida, India</i>
Summer Intern <i>Indian Realty Exchange, QUIKR India Pvt Ltd.</i>	Jun. 2016 – Jul. 2016 <i>Delhi, India</i>

Scholarships and Grants

Henry M. MacCracken Doctoral Fellowship <i>New York University</i>	2021-2026
GSAS Dean's Student Travel Grant <i>New York University</i>	2024
C.V. Starr Travel Grant <i>New York University</i>	2025, 2024
Prof. Late Suresh D.Tendulkar Memorial Scholarship <i>Delhi School of Economics</i>	2019-2020
Delhi University Post Graduate Scholarship <i>Delhi School of Economics</i>	2018-2019
KPMG Merit cum Need Scholarship <i>Shri Ram College of Commerce</i>	2017-2018
KPMG Merit cum Need Scholarship <i>Shri Ram College of Commerce</i>	2016-2017

Technical Skills

Languages: R, Python, Matlab, MySQL

Softwares: STATA, SAS Enterprise Guide, SAS Enterprise Miner, L^AT_EX, Microsoft Office

Languages

English (fluent), Hindi (native), French (basic)

Personal

Date of Birth: September 17, 1997

Citizenship: India

US Visa: F1 status